

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2019

Round 2



Solution and marking.

Scoring (max 17)

- 5.1: 1 point for each correct letter (max 14)
- 5.2: 1 point for each correct translation (max 3)

5.1.	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
	A	M	H	I	B	D	F	G	E	N	C	J	K	L
5.2.	təc	dog						cəs	feather					
	dex	top, upper part												

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Commentary

The challenge in this problem is to see semantic connections between the English translations which might motivate formal similarities in the Witsuwit'en. These connections are hinted at in the literal meanings in the middle column.

Witsuwit'en	literal meaning	English
1. bət	belly	A. abdomen, belly
5. dəlkw'aχ + dət'ay	frog + duck	B. bat (animal)
11. neɬdəc	blanket	C. blanket
6. dəlkw'aχ + neɬdəc	frog + blanket	D. broad leaf plantain
9. ɬəc + tɬ'ol	dog + rope	E. dog harness
7. dət'ay	duck	F. duck
8. dət'ay cəs	duck + feather	G. duck feather
3. dəlkw'aχ	frog	H. frog
4. dəlkw'aχ + bət	frog + belly	I. light blue
12. tɬ'oɬ	rope	J. rope
13. yəs	snow	K. snow
14. yəs + cəs	snow + feather	L. snowflake
2. bətdex	belly + top	M. upper part of stomach
10. ɬəc + yəs	dog + snow	N. wolf